

JEONGSOO SUH

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EDUCATION

Duke University

Ph.D. in Economics

2021 - 2026 (*expected*)

London School of Economics

M.Sc. in Economics (*with Distinction*)

2019 - 2021

Korea University

B.A. in Economics & B.S. in Financial Engineering (*with Great Honor*)

2013 - 2019

RESEARCH FIELDS

Labor Economics, Health Economics, Public Economics

JOB MARKET PAPER

“Child Protection in Response to Public Health Crises: Evidence from the Opioid Epidemic (solo-authored)”

Abstract: This paper examines the impacts of the opioid epidemic on child maltreatment and how Child Protective Services (CPS) responded to the epidemic. I use the reformulation of OxyContin, a nationwide supply shock in prescription opioids that exacerbated the opioid epidemic, as a natural experiment. Leveraging variation in states’ and counties’ exposure to this intervention, I find that the opioid epidemic led to an increase in maltreatment allegations, suggesting a rise in the underlying maltreatment risk. Despite heightened risk, institutional responses did not scale protective actions accordingly, resulting in more cases where children were left at home but subsequently reinvestigated for maltreatment. Foster care placement rates remained unchanged and administrative expenditures per allegation declined, pointing to a limited systemic response. This study underscores the inter-generational consequences of the opioid epidemic and highlights how public health crises can weaken protective systems, particularly when institutions lack the flexibility or capacity to adapt.

Presented at: Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Conference, Canadian Economics Association (CEA) Annual Meeting, Western Economic Association International (WEAI) 100th Conference, Economics Graduate Student Conference, Duke University Labor/Public Seminar

Scheduled at: Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting

WORKING PAPER

“Mechanism Reform for Task Allocation” (with E. Jason Baron, Richard Lombardo, Joseph Ryan, and Quitze Valenzuela-Stookey), *NBER Working Paper #32369*

Abstract: Reforming an existing system for allocating tasks among agents introduces additional political and institutional constraints relative to designing one in isolation. We develop a general mechanism-design framework for using data on agents’ performance to improve outcomes while ensuring that no agents are made worse off relative to the status quo. As an illustration, we apply our results to the assignment of Child Protective Services investigators to maltreatment cases. Simulations show the mechanism reduces false positives (unnecessary foster care placements) by up to 14% while also lowering false negatives (missed maltreatment cases) and overall placements.

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Effects of Controlling Prescription Opioids on Child Welfare”

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Program for Advanced Research in the Social Sciences Fellowship, Duke University	2025 - 2026
Merit-based Bonus for Head Teaching Assistant, Duke University	Spring 2023
Graduate School Summer Research Fellowship, Duke University	2022 - 2023
Economics Department Graduate Fellowship, Duke University	2021 - 2022
Great Honor (Equivalent to Summa Cum Laude), Korea University	2019
Semester High Honors, Korea University	2013 - 2014, 2016 - 2018
Merit-based Honors Scholarships, Korea University	2013 - 2014

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

Certificate in College Teaching, Duke University	
Formal, documented training in college teaching, with official transcript record	2026 (<i>expected</i>)
Instructor, Duke University	
Econometrics and Data Science (Undergraduate)	Summer 2024
Head Teaching Assistant, Duke University	
Statistical Foundations of Econometrics and Data Science (Undergraduate)	Fall 2022, Spring 2023
Department-Sponsored Tutor, Duke University	
Tutored Economics Ph.D. student in the first-year core Econometrics course	Fall 2022

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2025: Canadian Economics Association (CEA) Annual Meeting, Western Economic Association International (WEAI) 100th Conference, Economics Graduate Student Conference, Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting*, Duke University Labor/Public Seminar
2024: Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Conference, Duke University Labor/Public Seminar
2023: Duke University Labor/Public Seminar
*: Scheduled

SERVICE

Co-Organizer, Labor/Public Economics Seminar, Duke University Fall 2024, Spring 2025

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Military Service October 2014 - July 2016
Served as a Korean Augmentation To the United States Army (KATUSA)

SKILLS

Computer Skills	Stata, R, Python, Matlab, $\text{\LaTeX}$
Languages	Korean (Native), English (Fluent)